



power requirements from recently commissioned solar plants within the hotel's premises; set in the middle around it and the lake surrounding it are not polluted

And 68 per cent cited that recent news about climate change had influenced them to make more sustainable travel choices. To that end, 64 per cent of Indian travellers say that the sustainability efforts of accommodations and transport providers play a strong role in their property and transport decisions, respectively. In fact, 88 per cent of Indian travellers say they would be more likely to choose a sustainable accommodation—irrespective of whether they were specifically looking for one or not.

“Customers are beginning to demand it... And they want to know what you are doing to reduce it [your carbon footprint]. Consumers are significantly



“New technologies are helping us increase efficiencies, which in turn will reduce costs. Some of these are IoT-based and can be easily replicated across our hotels”

Gaurav Pokhariyal
EXECUTIVE VICE
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influencing the sustainability movement,” says Dilip Puri, Founder and CEO of the Indian School of Hospitality, and a veteran of the hospitality industry.

Anuraag Bhatnagar, COO of The Leela Palaces, Hotels and Resorts, agrees. “Sustainable luxury today is changing the paradigm as guests seek fulfilling experiences in harmony with nature and socio-cultural surroundings. Purposeful travel is becoming a trend and guests are choosing brands based on their sustainability initiatives and are, in fact, willing to pay a premium,” he says. The group has set aside ₹40 crore to reduce its carbon footprint. Currently, its five owned hotels (it manages another seven) are